Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 28 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Drizzle	Light rain
16° 9°	15° 9°	15° 9°	13° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Storm Boelo is still causing disruption across parts of the UK, with more high winds hitting Scotland and Northern Ireland.**

A Met Office weather warning is in place for much of Tuesday, as the clean-up operation continues in affected areas. Residents are being advised to take care.

WEATHER · UK

2 **There are warnings that the planned landline switchover to digital could leave vulnerable people cut off in an emergency.**

MPs are concerned that the switch, due by January, could particularly affect remote areas of the UK. Ministers have been urged to re-evaluate the plans.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

3 **The father of a boy who stabbed a girl at school says his son was radicalised online, calling for tighter controls on extreme material.**

His son was recently convicted of attempted murder. The father believes online content played a significant role in his son's actions.

CRIME · UK

4 **A coroner has warned that police failings in the deaths of two friends on a mountain ridge could risk other lives.**

Jayden Long and Eddie Hill died after police failed to adequately escalate a dropped 999 call. The coroner highlighted serious concerns about the handling of the incident.

PUBLIC SAFETY · UK

5 **The Chancellor is set to promise £15 million in the Budget to tackle misogyny, though some question its effectiveness.**

The funding aims to improve safety for women and girls. However, there are doubts within the Conservative party about whether this amount will make a significant difference.

POLITICS · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Music superstar Jay-Z is set to headline the Super Bowl half-time show, a first for the rapper.**

He has been involved with the production of the show for years, but this will be his debut as a performer at the NFL championship game. Fans are already buzzing about what he'll bring to the stage.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Super Bowl half-time show performance of all time?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **The Duchess of Sussex, Meghan, is joining the judging panel for Junior MasterChef Australia next year.**

She has expressed her excitement about taking part in the programme. It's expected to be a big hit with viewers when it airs.

ON AIR — Which celebrity chef would you love to see join a cooking show?

TV · COMING UP

3 **The hugely popular video game Cyberpunk 2077 is getting a live-action movie adaptation by Paramount Pictures.**

The game, from the studio behind The Witcher series, was a smash hit. Fans are eagerly anticipating how the futuristic world will translate to the big screen.

ON AIR — What's your favourite video game adaptation, or one you'd love to see made?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Nigerian Afrobeats star Ayra Starr is making history as the first African artist to headline an international NFL half-time show.**

This is a huge moment for Afrobeats music and for Ayra Starr herself. She's set to bring her unique sound to a massive global audience.

ON AIR — Who is your favourite Afrobeats artist at the moment?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **Fans of the 'romantasy' book series 'A Court of Thorns and Roses' are celebrating the release of the latest Sarah J Maas book.**

About 40 fans gathered for a special 'lock-in' event in Carrickfergus to mark the occasion. The series has a dedicated following who love escaping into its fantastical world.

ON AIR — Are you a fan of 'romantasy' books, or have you discovered a new favourite genre recently?

BOOKS · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Football fans are in for a treat this Saturday, as the first Milan derby of the season will be shown live.**

It's always a fiercely contested match between Inter and AC Milan. This promises to be a thrilling encounter for football lovers.

ON AIR — Which derby in football do you think is the most exciting or intense?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Harry Kane has been hailed as the 'anti-superstar' who defied doubters to achieve Ballon d'Or greatness.**

The chief football writer Phil McNulty described him as humble, yet he has now been crowned the world's best player. It's a fantastic achievement for the England captain.

ON AIR — Do you agree that Harry Kane is an 'anti-superstar', or just a brilliant, humble player?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England faces a 'do or die' Rugby League World Cup game against Samoa in their final group match.**

Coach Stuart Barrow has emphasised the importance of the game. It's all to play for as England look to secure their spot in the next round.

ON AIR — What's your favourite memory from a Rugby League World Cup?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

4 **Formula 1 is proposing simpler, cheaper hybrid V8 engines for its next set of regulations.**

The aim is to make the sport more accessible and sustainable. It could lead to some exciting changes on the track in the coming seasons.

ON AIR — Do you think simpler engines will make Formula 1 more competitive or less exciting?

FORMULA 1 · UK

5 **Rangers manager Derek McInnes admits feeling 'guilt' over leaving Hearts for Ibrox, ahead of his return to Tynecastle.**

He accepts that he might face a rough reception from the Hearts fans on Wednesday. It's sure to be an emotional return for the manager.

ON AIR — Have you ever seen a manager return to their old club and get a really hostile reception?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The simple joy of 'finding a perfectly ripe avocado' is being celebrated as a small, yet significant, daily triumph.**
Many are sharing stories of their avocado-hunting successes, noting the immediate uplift in mood that comes with selecting the ideal specimen. It seems a well-timed avocado can truly brighten your day!

2 **People are finding unexpected satisfaction in the precise art of 'folding laundry' into perfectly neat piles.**
What was once a mundane chore is now becoming a mindful practice for some, with online communities sharing tips and tricks for achieving pristine linen stacks. There's a certain calm in a well-ordered drawer.

3 **The delightful discovery of 'a forgotten snack' in a coat pocket is proving to be a cheerful surprise for many.**
Whether it's a biscuit, a chocolate bar, or a packet of crisps, stumbling upon an unexpected treat provides a small, delightful moment of joy. It's like a tiny gift from your past self!

4 **The quiet charm of 'watching a cat nap in a sunbeam' is being highlighted as a source of peaceful contemplation.**
The serene image of a contented feline soaking up the warmth is a gentle reminder to slow down and appreciate life's simple pleasures. It’s hard to feel stressed when you see such pure relaxation.

5 **There's a growing appreciation for the 'subtle scent of old books' as a comforting aroma.**
Book lovers are increasingly recognising the unique, earthy fragrance of aged paper and bindings as a source of nostalgia and warmth. It's a smell that instantly transports you to quiet libraries and cosy reading nooks.

6 **The satisfying 'thud' of a post landing on the doormat is bringing a small moment of analogue delight.**
In our increasingly digital world, the arrival of physical mail, especially something pleasant, offers a brief, tangible connection to the outside world. There's something reassuring about that sound.

7 **The humble 'garden shed' is undergoing a renaissance, becoming a personalised sanctuary for many.**
Beyond tools and potting compost, sheds are being transformed into hobby spaces, quiet reading rooms, or even miniature home offices. It's a little world of your own, just steps away from the main house.

Prepflow

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if a new plant in a shop is healthy, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GENTLY WOBBLING THE POT TO CHECK IF IT FEELS 'STABLE' AND 'WELL-ROOTED'.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of jam, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: GAZING AT THE LABEL FOR A FULL MINUTE, ADMIRING THE 'CRAFTSMANSHIP' BEFORE DARING TO OPEN IT.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' just instantly makes you feel cosy or happy?**
  It could be the gentle hum of the fridge, the distant sound of church bells, or even the familiar chatter of your neighbours. What's that one sound that just warms your heart, and why?

- **We all have that 'one particular mug' that we always reach for, don't we?**
  It might be chipped, a bit faded, or perhaps it has a funny picture on it, but it's your go-to for that perfect cuppa. Tell us about your favourite mug – what makes it so special?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that squirrels are so forgetful they actually plant thousands of new trees every year by burying nuts and then completely forgetting where they put them?

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The official residence of the British monarch in London, Buckingham Palace, has 775 rooms.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, as they have been observed at altitudes of up to 9,000 metres.
- The world's smallest commercially available car is the Peel P50, a three-wheeled microcar made in the Isle of Man.
- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a group of berries that have fused together.
- The British Library in London holds over 170 million items, making it the second-largest library in the world by number of items.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the beta-carotene in their diet, mainly from brine shrimp and algae.
- The first ever webcam was created at Cambridge University to monitor a coffee pot so staff wouldn't make wasted trips.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, which is roughly the same as 100 elephants.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 28 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 301 of the year, 64 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdias of Babylon; Christian feast day: Abgar V of Edessa (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Eadsige; Christian feast day: Faro. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Greg Eagles, American voice actor and producer
- 1978 — Gwendoline Christie, English actress
- 1980 — Alan Smith, English footballer and coach
- 1966 — Andy Richter, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1945 — Wayne Fontana, English pop singer (died 2020)
- 1987 — Frank Ocean, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Javier Grillo-Marxuach, Puerto Rican screenwriter and producer
- 1985 — Tyrone Barnett, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1942 — The Alaska Highway first connects Alaska to the North American railway network at Dawson Creek in Canada.
- 2023 — The 2023 Rugby World Cup final is held at the Stade de France in Saint-Denis, France. It saw South Africa defeat New Zealand 12 to 11, claiming their fourth Webb Ellis Cup, becoming the first nation to do so.
- 2014 — A rocket carrying NASA's Cygnus CRS Orb-3 resupply mission to the International Space Station explodes seconds after taking off from the Mid-Atlantic Regional Spaceport in Wallops Island, Virginia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2009 — NASA successfully launches the Ares I-X mission, the only rocket launch for its short-lived Constellation program.
- 1982 — The Spanish general election begins fourteen years of rule by the Spanish Socialist Workers' Party.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1965 — Pope Paul VI promulgates Nostra aetate, by which the Roman Catholic Church officially recognizes the legitimacy of non-Christian faiths.
- 2007 — Cristina Fernández de Kirchner becomes the first directly elected female President of Argentina.

- 1948 — Paul Hermann Müller is awarded the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for his discovery of the insecticidal properties of DDT.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 29 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 302 of the year, 63 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham of Rostov; Christian feast day: Blessed Chiara Badano; Christian feast day: Colman mac Duagh; Christian feast day: Douai Martyrs. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Winona Ryder, American actress and producer
- 1976 — Stephen Craigan, Irish footballer and manager
- 1955 — Kevin DuBrow, American heavy metal singer-songwriter (died 2007)
- 1943 — Don Simpson, American actor, producer, and screenwriter (died 1996)
- 1949 — Kieron Baker, English footballer
- 1948 — Kate Jackson, American actress, director, and producer
- 1986 — Italia Ricci, Canadian actress
- 1944 — Denny Laine, English singer-songwriter and musician (died 2023)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Space Shuttle Discovery blasts off on STS-95 with 77-year-old John Glenn on board, making him the oldest person to go into space at that time.
- 1999 — A large cyclone devastates Odisha, India.
- 2018 — Lion Air Flight 610, a Boeing 737 MAX, crashes after taking off from Jakarta, Indonesia killing 189 people on board. This is the first of two crashes that will lead to the plane being grounded worldwide.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Major General Samuel K. Doe is announced as the winner of the first multi-party election in Liberia.
- 1986 — British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher opens the last stretch of the M25 motorway.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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